Who Gets an ESG Score? Coverage Selection and Firm Value in Five Southeast Asian Markets[1]

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Declaration of generative AI and AI-assisted technologies

The authors used Claude (Anthropic), through Claude Code, in September and October 2026 to screen candidate research questions, draft the pre-analysis plan, write and check the R code, edit and revise the text, check references, and simulate referee reports, and in October 2026 to carry out the additional analyses requested in the review, draft the revised text, and draft the response letter. The authors reviewed every output, checked each reported number against the R output files, and take full responsibility for the content. Claude is not an author.

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Conflict of interest disclosure

The authors have nothing to disclose.

Data availability statement

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The ESG scores (LSEG Workspace) and the accounting and market data (Compustat Global) are licensed, and the licenses do not allow the authors to redistribute them, including firm identifiers and derived firm-level variables; the download date of the scores was not recorded. The R code, the pre-analysis plan, and all aggregate output files will be deposited in a public repository with a DOI before final acceptance. Researchers with access to the two databases can rebuild the sample with the code.

Ethics approval statement

Not applicable. The study uses firm-level secondary data and involves no human participants.

Author contributions

Ha Hong Hanh: supervision, validation, and writing (review and editing); she directed the revision. Nguyen Van Trung: conceptualization, data curation, formal analysis, methodology, software, visualization, and writing (original draft, review and editing).